

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Evolution, not a sudden creed

1563 -> pilgrim tax remitted | 1564 -> jizyah abolished

1575 -> Ibadat Khana built at Fatehpur Sikri

1578 -> debates widened beyond Muslim participants

1579 -> Mahzar gives Akbar a bounded arbitral role

1580-81 -> rebellion and orthodox opposition sharpen the sovereignty issue

1581-82 -> public debates close; Tauhid-i-Ilahi discipleship phase emerges.

MUST REMEMBER: Ibadat Khana (1575), Mahzar (1579), sulh-i kul and Tauhid-i-Ilahi belong to an evolving imperial debate.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Five layers of Akbar's religious policy

PERSONAL -> Chishti links, inquiry, prayer and spiritual search

FISCAL -> selected religious disabilities removed in 1563-64

INTELLECTUAL -> Ibadat Khana, translations and comparative encounter

SOVEREIGN -> Mahzar and final imperial arbitration

GOVERNING -> sulh-i-kul, justice and non-sectarian accommodation

DISCIPLESHIP -> small Tauhid-i-Ilahi circle around the sovereign.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Ibadat Khana debate cycle

BUILD 1575 -> court-linked prayer and disputation forum

FIRST PHASE -> ulama, Sufis, scholars and companions

CONFLICT -> doctrine, precedence and court status become entangled

WIDENING -> Hindu, Jain, Christian and Zoroastrian interlocutors

PARADOX -> more voices, but no shared theological settlement

CLOSURE -> public forum ends; private inquiry and translation continue.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Interfaith encounter: influence is not conversion

HINDU -> interlocutors and translation | not Akbar becoming Hindu

JAIN -> petitions and animal-life concerns | not a universal permanent ban

JESUIT -> books, images and theology | courtesy is not Christian conversion

ZOROASTRIAN -> Meherji Rana and light symbols | symbolism is not adoption

SUFI-ISLAMIC -> tawhid and pir-murid idiom remain central continuities

RULE: state the encounter, evidence, bounded influence and non-equivalence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The debate paradox

ROYAL FORUM -> participants compete before the emperor

DOCTRINAL CERTAINTY -> argument hardens rather than dissolves

COURT STATUS -> theological dispute also becomes political rivalry

AKBAR'S LESSON -> no one clerical network can secure plural order

POLICY SHIFT -> theological concord yields to non-sectarian governance

VERDICT: dialogue failed as consensus but mattered for statecraft.

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Mahzar: scope before significance

MYTH -> Akbar became pope, prophet or an infallible lawgiver

RULE -> after jurists disagree, he selects an existing opinion for public welfare

SIGNIFICANCE -> clerical monopoly narrows as imperial arbitration grows

LIMIT -> bounded juristic choice is not unlimited sacred legislation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Sulh-i-kul as a governing principle

PROBLEM -> a plural, ranked empire needs order beyond theological agreement

MECHANISM -> justice, tax reform, wider service and calibrated patronage

LIMIT -> the emperor still defines inclusion, protection and coercion

VERDICT: durable imperial idiom, not modern constitutional secularism.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Tauhid-i-Ilahi: neither mass religion nor nothing

ABSENT -> scripture, priesthood, congregation and mass mission

PRESENT -> initiation, conduct, greetings and graded devotion language

SCALE / IDIOM -> small elite circle; Birbal; Sufi-like guide-disciple bond

VERDICT: loyalist spiritual fellowship, not a new universal religion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Inclusion and coercion in one empire

INCLUSION -> tax relief, service, dialogue and non-sectarian justice

HIERARCHY / COERCION -> rank, conquest and punishment remain sovereign tools

SOCIAL LIMIT -> orders are uneven; policy depends on the ruler

RULE: praise innovation without inventing equality or neutrality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Source triangle and evidentiary limits

ABUL FAZL -> policy and kingship | courtly legitimation

BADAUNI / JESUITS -> dissent and encounter | polemic and conversion hopes

ORDERS / ARCHITECTURE -> policy acts and setting | uneven reach, no transcript

METHOD: state what each source proves, cannot prove and needs checked.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Din-i-Ilahi/Tauhid-i-Ilahi was a restricted ethical discipleship, not a mass religion with a population census.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: 2025 GS-I syncretism answer map

OPEN -> layered state-building programme, not a sudden mass faith

EARLY -> 1563-64 fiscal change; Ibadat Khana inquiry and widening

STATE -> Mahzar arbitration; sulh-i-kul and composite legitimacy

CLOSE -> Tauhid fellowship was small and policy remained ruler-centred.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Abul Fazl, Badauni and later historians supply differently positioned evidence that must be attributed and compared.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 17 final answer spine

DEFINE -> separate belief, debate, sovereignty, governance and fellowship

TRACE -> 1563-64 -> 1575 -> 1578 -> 1579 -> 1581-82

PROVE -> taxes, Ibadat Khana, Mahzar, sulh-i-kul and Tauhid evidence

ANALYSE -> plural empire, elite integration and public order

QUALIFY -> source bias, coercion, hierarchy and limited implementation

VERDICT -> innovative state formation, not modern secularism or mass religion.